

Google set to speed up Android security update releases

Google is working on upgrading the security update system for Android. The search giant has started working with third-party manufacturers and cell phone carriers to improve the speed of security updates and make the open source platform more secure.

Almost half of Android users do not receive important security updates. Google pushed updates to 735 million devices last year, but half of them did not receive the patch from device manufacturers. Therefore, the company is aiming to push the updates within just a few days from release by working with carriers and manufacturers.



“We provided monthly security updates for all supported Pixel and Nexus devices throughout 2016, and we are thrilled to see our partners invest significantly in regular updates as well. There is still a lot of room for improvement, however,” Google’s Android security team members Adrian Ludwig and Mel Miller, wrote in a blog post.

Pushing the updates to Android devices, except the Nexus and Pixel models, is a complex process. Device manufacturers and carriers have to compile the patch to match the device’s requirements.

Working with manufacturers and carriers to restructure the updates release system can certainly speed up the delivery schedule of security updates for Android. However, it is impossible to ensure the protection of the over 1.4 billion Android users worldwide.

Huawei’s KunLun server to run SUSE Linux Enterprise Server

Huawei has announced its partnership with SUSE to bring SUSE Linux Enterprise Server as the preferred standard OS for its KunLun RAS 2.0. The open source platform supposedly comes with reliability, availability and serviceability features for the server, and the combination brings an ‘always online’ offering for enterprises.

At CeBIT 2016, Huawei and SUSE jointly launched KunLun as the world’s first 32-socket mission critical server. That tie-up influenced both the companies to move a step ahead and ultimately made SUSE Linux Enterprise Server the preferred standard operating system.

“Now we bring our partnership to a new level by releasing the industry’s first standard Linux OS that supports KunLun RAS 2.0. The OS will help KunLun deliver reliability that is parallel to, and even surpasses that of traditional high-end UNIX servers. These benefits will translate into a better return on investment for our customers,” said Wang Zhen, vice president for IT, server product line, Huawei.

The operating system for KunLun is based on SUSE Linux Enterprise Server 12 Service Pack 2. It supports RAS 2.0 features that allow customers to add or remove CPU and memory resources without shutting down the system.

“SUSE leads the industry by releasing the preferred standard OS that supports KunLun RAS 2.0 features, including CPU and memory hot swap,” said Ralf Flaxa, president of engineering at SUSE. The SUSE team led by Flaxa is also developing an in-service kernel upgrade feature in order to deliver all the latest updates to the Linux-backed platform.

Huawei has designed KunLun to address the high reliability, performance and scalability requirements of mission-critical environments by leveraging the x86 ecosystem. The company claims that the server can overcome the longstanding restrictions of enclosed architectures.

Google releases Android O and aims to improve battery life

While you might be waiting to test your apps on Android Nougat, Google has moved a step ahead and released the first developer preview of Android O. The focus of the new open source project is supposedly to improve battery life and enhance performance on compatible devices.

Battery life is one big concern on Android devices. Though Android engineers at Google had tried to fix various bugs on its Lollipop, Marshmallow and the recent Nougat versions, the issue persists — on almost all the smartphones and tablets.

But with Android O, the Sunder Pichai-led team is planning to deliver a better experience by enabling some automatic limits on apps running in the background. This advances the power optimisation that was a part of the Nougat release last year.

“Building on the work we began in Nougat, Android O places a big priority on improving a user’s battery life and a device’s interactive performance. To make this possible, we have put additional automatic limits on what apps can do in the background, in three main areas — implicit broadcasts, background services and location updates,” explains Dave Burke, vice president of engineering at Google, in a blog post.

The latest changes supposedly enable apps to have minimal impact on the hardware and this enhances the battery life.

Developers are recommended to learn the tweaks to make their apps compatible with the new background limits. Google has already got documentation ready on background execution limits and background location limits to make things easier for app makers.

Alongside the enhancements to improve battery life, Android O is all about an